

THE SMALL INTESTINE (Surgery) — Revision Table

Bold = high-yield. Dr Mezjda Rashaan.

ANATOMY & DIVERTICULA

Topic	Key points
Function/anatomy	B12 absorption; GALT; ligament of Treitz , valvulae conniventes , Peyer's patches ; Cajal cells = pacemaker
Meckel's	Rule of 2s (2%, 2 inches, 2 feet from ICV, M:F equal, <2yrs); 60% gastric mucosa ; vitelline duct; painless GI bleed in children ; Tc-99m scan; Littre's hernia ; diverticulectomy if symptomatic
Duodenal	Periampullary; cholangitis/pancreatitis/Oddi dysfunction; ERCP problem
Jejunal	Connective tissue disease; malabsorption, B12 deficiency
Blind loop	Stasis → bacteria → malabsorption (fat + B12) , steatorrhoea

CROHN'S DISEASE

Aspect	Key points
Features	F>M, 15–30; terminal ileum 60% , mouth→anus; smoking ↑3×
Pathology	Transmural non-caseating granuloma ; skip lesions; cobblestone ; rectal sparing
Extra-intestinal	Sclerosing cholangitis , ankylosing spondylitis , erythema nodosum , pyoderma gangrenosum
Investigations	Barium = string sign of Kantor ; MRI perianal
Treatment	Steroid + 5-ASA + azathioprine ; surgery for complications only (obstruction, fistula); stricturoplasty

INFECTIONS & FISTULA

Condition	Key points
Amoebiasis	E. histolytica; bottlenecked ulcer (sigmoid/rectum); metronidazole + diloxanide
Intestinal TB	Ulcerative (2° pulmonary) vs hyperplastic (ileocaecal) ; rarely fistula (unlike Crohn's)
Typhoid	Lower ileum longitudinal ulcer; perforation/haemorrhage
Fistula	>80% iatrogenic ; 90% close in 5 wks ; FRIEND (Foreign body, Radiation, Inflammation, Epithelialization, Neoplasm, Distal obstruction)

TUMOURS

Tumour	Key points
Overview	Rare (1–2% of GI cancers); duodenum > ileum
Benign	Adenoma commonest ; Peutz-Jeghers (hamartoma + mucocutaneous melanosis)
Adenocarcinoma	35–50%; risk Crohn's/coeliac/FAP; resection
Carcinoid	Enterochromaffin; serotonin/5-HIAA ; crisis only with metastases (flushing, right heart fibrosis) ; somatostatin
Lymphoma	Western (B), Mediterranean (alpha-chain) , coeliac (T-cell)
GIST	KIT (CD117) mutation , Cajal cells ; mostly stomach; imatinib